

Hyunah Ahn

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UPDATED: January 10, 2026

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Second Language Studies
University of Hawaii at Manoa (UHM), Honolulu, Hawaii

Doctoral studies in English Language & Literature
Seoul National University, Seoul, Korea

M.A. in TESOL
Michigan State University, East Lansing, Michigan

B.A. in English Language and Literature (Minor: Psychology)
Ajou University, Suwon, Korea

EMPLOYMENT

2022-present || Department of English Language and Literature, Kunsan National University
2025-present: Department Chair
2022-present: Assistant Professor

2017-2022 || Lecturer
Department of English Language and Literature, Seoul National University (2017-2022)
Department of English Language and Literature, Korea University (Winter 2020)
Dasan University College, Ajou University, Suwon, Korea (AY2018, Fall 2008)
Kyonggi University, Suwon, Korea (Fall 2017)

2010-2017 || Graduate Assistant
University of Hawaii at Manoa, Honolulu, HI, USA

GRANTS

2022 New Faculty Research Grant
“The acquisition of psych-predicates in Korean as a second language”
Kunsan National University, Gunsan, Korea

2021 NRF Research Grant (# 2021S1A5B5A17048833)
Humanities and Social Sciences Academic Research Professor (14 million Korean won)
“The resolution of null arguments in Korean as a second language”
National Research Foundation of Korea, Daejeon, Korea

2020 NRF Research Grant (# 2020S1A5B5A17089402)
Humanities and Social Sciences Academic Research Professor (14 million Korean won)
“The effect of non-linguistic information in L2 processing of active and passive constructions” National Research Foundation of Korea, Daejeon, Korea

- 2019 NRF Research Grant (# 2019S1A5B5A07111230)
 Research fund for Next Generation Researchers (14 million Korean won)
 “An investigation of exemplar-based language learning using psychological predicates in Korean” National Research Foundation of Korea, Daejeon, Korea
- 2018 NRF Research Grant (# 2018S1A5B5A07071643)
 Research fund for Next Generation Researchers (14 million Korean won)
 “The integration of multiple types of information in real-time second language processing”
 National Research Foundation of Korea, Daejeon, Korea
- 2015 East-West Center Field Research Grant
 Research fund for doctoral dissertation (covered expenditures for travel to research site, participant compensation, and other research related activities); Merit-based competition
 East-West Center, Honolulu, HI
- 2015 *Language Learning* Dissertation Grant
 Merit-based competition hosted by *Language Learning* (Wiley)
 The *Language Learning* Dissertation Grant Program

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed Journals

- Ahn, H.** (2025). Null pronoun interpretation probed via thematic role ambiguity: A case in Korean. *Linguistics Vanguard*, 11(1), 231-246. <https://doi.org/10.1515/lingvan-2025-0065>
- Ahn, H.** (2025). From items to morphemes: A comparative Rasch analysis of Korean C-test scoring. *Foreign Languages Education*, 26(4), 23-44. <http://dx.doi.org/10.15334/FLE.2025.32.3.93>
- Ahn, H. & Mariano, G.** (2024). The morphological distribution of English two-place psych-predicates in children’s language input. *Studies in English Language & Literature*, 50(4). <https://dx.doi.org/10.21559/aellk.2024.50.4.011>
- Ahn, H.** (2024). The argument drop patterns of the psych-predicate *mwusep-* in spoken, written, and messenger corpora. *Studies in English Language & Literature*, 50(2), 153-173. <https://dx.doi.org/10.21559/aellk.2024.50.2.008>
- Ahn, H. & Song, M.-J.** (2023). L1 Korean speakers’ definiteness processing in L2 English: A visual world paradigm eye-tracking study. *Bilingualism: Language and Cognition*, 26(3), 556-569. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S1366728922000840> (ISSN: 1366-7289, Online ISSN: 1469-1841)
- Ahn, H.** (2022). L2 Processing of linguistic and non-linguistic information: L2 speakers use definiteness if real-world knowledge is unusable. *Studies in Second Language Acquisition*, 44(2), 507-535. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S0272263121000322> (ISSN: 0272-2631; Online ISSN: 1470-1545)
- Ahn, H.** (2021). From Interlanguage grammar to target grammar in L2 processing of definiteness as uniqueness. *Second Language Research*, 37(1), 91-119. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0267658319868003> (ISSN: 0267-6583)

- Ahn, H.** (2020). L2 Korean speakers' thematic role resolution in a psych-predicate construction. *Language Research*, 56(2), 141-165. <https://doi.org/10.30961/lr.2020.56.2.141>
- Ahn, H.** (2018). Prosody, syntax, and discourse: A three-way interaction. *Korean Journal of Linguistics*, 43(1), 73-100. <https://www.dbpia.co.kr/Article/NODE07449324> (ISSN:1229-4039)
- Ahn, H.** (2017). The prosodic resolution of syntactic/semantic ambiguity: An exemplar-based account. *Language Research*, 53(3), 501-524. <https://doi.org/10.30961/lr.2017.53.3.501> (pISSN: 0254-5574)
<https://web.stanford.edu/group/cslipublications/cslipublications/site/9781575867526.shtml>
- Kim, S. & **Ahn, H.** (2007). Expectations and needs analysis of M.A. TESOL students in the USA. *Modern English Education*, 8(2), 75-93. <http://uci.or.kr/G704-001860.2007.8.2.004>

Doctoral Dissertation

- Ahn, H.** (2017). *The integration of linguistic and non-linguistic information in L2 sentence processing* (Doctoral dissertation). University of Hawaii at Manoa, Honolulu, HI. Available from ProQuest Dissertations & Theses Global (ProQuest document ID: 1953257187). (ISBN: 978-0-35526-430-2)

Peer-Reviewed Conference Proceedings

- Ahn, H.** (2016). Reference in discourse: The case of L2 and heritage Korean. In M. Kenstowicz, T. Levin, & R. Masuda (Eds.), *Proceedings of the 23rd Japanese/Korean Linguistics Conference*. Stanford: CSLI Publications.(ISBN: 978-1-57586-752-6; 978-1-57586-841-7)
<https://web.stanford.edu/group/cslipublications/cslipublications/site/9781575867526.shtml>
- Ahn, H.** (2012). Prosodic boundaries and null arguments in L2 Korean. In A. K. Biller, E. Y. Chung, & A. E. Kimball (Eds.), *Proceedings of the 36th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development*. Somerville, MA: Cascadilla Press.(ISBN: 978-1-57473-075-3; 978-1-57473-175-0) <http://www.cascadilla.com/bucl36toc.html>

Edited Books

- Ahn, H.**, Clements, N., Lim, H., Lim, J., & Park, Y. (2020). *New Teachers' Guidebook*. Faculty of Liberal Education. Seoul National University.
- Ahn, H.**, & Vidal, M. (2012). *Proceedings of the 16th Annual College of Languages, Linguistics and Literature Graduate Student Conference*, University of Hawaii at Manoa
<http://hdl.handle.net/10125/14565>

Working Paper

- Ahn, H.** (2009). English article use by non-native English teachers in Korea: Task-type variability in Interlanguage performance and its pedagogical implications. *SNU Working Papers in English Linguistics and Language* 8, 43-58. <http://hdl.handle.net/10371/21465>

PRESENTATIONS

Invited Talks

2018 Invited speaker for the 104th Colloquium

At the Department of English Language and Literature, Seoul National University

“Processing language with non-linguistic information”

Seoul, Korea, April 27

2016 Invited speaker for the Department of Linguistics Colloquium

At California State University at Fresno

“The Integration of linguistic and non-Linguistic information in L2 sentence processing”

Fresno, CA, February 29

Oral Presentations

Ahn, H. (2024). The Fall Conference of the Association of English Language and Literature of Korea

“The good-enough processing of English psych-verbs.”

Kunsan National University, Gunsan, Korea

Ahn, H. & Mariano, G. (2024). The Spring Conference of the Association of English Language and Literature of Korea

“The distribution of past and present participial forms of psych-verbs in English.”

Kunsan National University, Gunsan, Korea

Ahn, H. (2023). The Fall Conference of the Association of English Language and Literature of Korea

“L2 processing of morphological distinction in English psych-verbs”

Jeonbuk National University, Jeonju, Korea

Ahn, H. (2022). The Joint Fall Conference of the English Linguistics Society of Korea and The Discourse and Cognitive Linguistics Society of Korea:

“Resolving ambiguity in a null argument construction with two-place psych-predicates”

Hankuk University of Foreign Studies, November 5

Ahn, H. (2022). The 2022 Seoul International Conference on Linguistics:

“The thematic role interpretation of overt NPs in a null argument construction”

Virtual online conference, August 11

Ahn, H. & Song, M. (2019). Second Language Research Forum 2019:

“The role of definiteness in predictive L2 sentence processing: An eye-tracking study”

Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI, September 21

Ahn, H. (2018). 2018 SNU International Conference on Linguistics:

“Simultaneous processing of grammar and world knowledge in second language”

Seoul National University, Seoul, Korea, June 15

Ahn, H. (2017). The 2017 Fall Conference of the Linguistic Society of Korea :

“Prosody, syntax, and discourse: An exemplar-based account of the interface.”

Seoul National University. Seoul, Korea, November 24

- Ahn, H. (2016). The 41st Boston University Conference on Language Development:
 “The integration of linguistic and non-linguistic information in L2 processing”
 Boston, MA, November 4
- Ahn, H. (2016). The 35th Second Language Research Forum:
 “The incremental processing of linguistic vs. non-linguistic information in L2”
 Columbia University, New York, NY, September 23
- Ahn, H. (2015). International Conference on Korean Linguistics / Harvard International Symposium on Korean Linguistics Joint Conference:
 “The disambiguating effect of intermediate phrases (ip) in Korean prosody and discourse”
 University of Chicago, Chicago, IL, July 25
- Ahn, H. (2013). The 23rd Japanese/Korean Linguistics Conference:
 “The accessibility and the form of a referent in discourse: The case of L2 and Heritage Korean”
 Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Boston, MA, October 11
- Ahn, H. (2013). The 35th Language Testing Research Colloquium:
 “Morpheme-by-morpheme Rasch analysis of a Korean C-test as a diagnostic tool”
 Seoul, Korea, July 4
- Ahn, H. (2013). The 12th Generative Approaches to Second Language Acquisition Conference:
 “Topicality and argument drop patterns in L2 Korean and Heritage Korean”
 University of Florida, Gainesville, FL, April 27
- Ahn, H. (2011). The 36th Boston University Conference on Language Development:
 “The role of prosody in thematic role disambiguation in L2 Korean”
 Boston, MA, November 5
- Ahn, H. (2010). American Association of Applied Linguistics (AAAL):
 “Causes of English article misuse: A case of Korean EFL learners”
 Atlanta, GA, March 6
- Ahn, H. (2009). Association of Pacific Rim Universities Doctoral Students Conference:
 “English article use by nonnative English teachers in Korea: Task-type variability in Interlanguage performance and its pedagogical implications”
 Kyoto University, Kyoto, Japan, July 9

Poster Presentations

- Ahn, H. (2018). The 92nd Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America:
 “The role of real-world knowledge in second language sentence processing.”
 Salt Lake City, Utah, January 4
- Ahn, H. (2016). The 5th Joint Meeting of the Acoustic Society of America and the Acoustic Society of Japan:
 “Two types of intermediate phrases (ip) in Korean”
 Honolulu, HI, December 2
- Ahn, H. (2016). The 29th Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing:
 “Slow NOT Shallow Processing of (In)definiteness in L2 English”
 University of Florida, Gainesville, FL, March 5

- Ahn, H. (2015). Chuo University-University of Hawaii at Manoa Student Conference on Linguistics, Psycholinguistics, and Second Language Acquisition:
 “The processing and accommodation of definiteness as uniqueness in L2 English”
 University of Hawaii at Manoa, Honolulu, HI, September 15
- Ahn, H. (2014). The 39th Boston University Conference on Language Development:
 “Definiteness as uniqueness in L2 English article use” Boston, MA, November 8
- Ahn, H. (2012). The 163th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America:
 “Boundary tones in comprehension & production of a pro-drop language: The case of Korean”
 Hong Kong, May 18
- Ahn, H. (2011). The 21st Japanese/Korean Linguistics Conference:
 “The role of prosody in thematic role disambiguation in Korean”
 Seoul National University, Seoul, Korea, October 21
- Ahn, H. (2011). Experimental and Theoretical Advances in Prosody (ETAP):
 “Intonational Phrase boundary tones and argument drop patterns in Korean”
 McGill University, Montreal, Canada, September 24
- Ahn, H. (2009). Second Language Research Forum (SLRF):
 “Interlanguage performance of trainees in an in-service teacher training program in Korea:
 Task type variability in English article use”
 Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI, October 31

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Experience in Korea

Affiliation	Courses	Semester
Kunsan National University	Computation & English Linguistics	F2025
	Studies in applied linguistics 1, 2	F2022, S2023
	Research Methods in English linguistics	S2022, S2024
	English Phonetics & Phonology	F2022-2025
	English Listening Practice	Spring every other year
	Practical English	Spring every other year
	English 1, 2	AY2022-25
Seoul National University	Seminar in Applied Linguistics	F2020
	Research Methods in English Linguistics	F2019
	Modern Society and Global Language	F2021, AY2019, F2017
	Advanced English: Culture and Society	W2019, S2019
	Advanced English: Exploring Film	S2018
	College English 2: Speaking	AY2021, S2020, U2019, U2018
	College English 1	U2019, AY2018
Korea Univ.	English Foundations	S2020
	Psycholinguistics	W2020
Ajou Univ.	English 2	AY2018, W2017, F2008
	Practical English Grammar	S2018
Kyonggi Univ.	Teaching Methods of L2 English Writing	F2017

S=Spring, U=Summer, F=Fall, W=Winter, AY=Academic Year (S & F)

Experience at University of Hawaii at Manoa

Affiliation	Courses	Semester
Second Language Studies	SLS460	S2017, S2016, S2015, F2013
	SLS302	F2016, S2014, S2013, F2012
	SLS441	F2014, S2012, F2011
Hawaii English Language Program (HELP)	311P	F2015
	311S	F2015
English Language Institute	ELI73	F2010

Other teaching experience

Fall 2015 Tutor, Korean as a second language

Korean Language Flagship Center, University of Hawaii at Manoa

2007 - 2010 || Instructor, In-service Teacher Training Program, College of Education
Ajou University, Suwon, Korea

2003-2008 Instructor, Test-preparation courses (TOEFL, TOEIC, TEPS)
Lee Ik-Hoon Language School, Seoul, Korea

OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

Spring 2011 Teachers' Online Resource Room improvement project

English Language Institute, University of Hawaii at Manoa, Honolulu, HI

2010 - 2011 || Head Graduate Assistant for the phonetics lab

Language Analysis & Experimentation Labs at University of Hawaii at Manoa

2009 - 2010 || Coordinator for Monthly TEPS (Test of English Proficiency by Seoul National University) test-item writers

2009 Assistant Researcher for iTEPS (Internet-based TEPS)

2009 Assistant Researcher for SNULT (Seoul National University Language Test)

2008 - 2010 || Teaching Assistantship

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

2023 Understanding Principles and Techniques in College Student Counseling
Higher Education Training Institute, Online Workshop

2019 Team-Based Learning

Center for Teaching and Learning, Seoul National University

2019 Student Counseling Workshop

Center for Teaching and Learning, Seoul National University

- 2016 SLS B.A. program curriculum mapping workshop
Department of Second Language Studies, University of Hawaii at Manoa
- 2015 SLS B.A. program outcomes assessment workshop
Department of Second Language Studies, University of Hawaii at Manoa
- 2012 Summer workshop on computational linguistics
Seoul National University, Seoul, Korea
- 2011 Linguistic Society of America Summer Institute
University of Colorado, Boulder, CO

SERVICE

Academic Services

Journal Reviews

- Studies in Second Language Acquisition* (Cambridge University Press; 2020, 2025)
- Language & Cognition* (Cambridge University Press, 2025)
- International Journal of Applied Linguistics* (Wiley, 2025)
- Second Language Research* (Sage; 2018-present)
- Lingua* (Elsevier; 2024)
- Language Acquisition* (Taylor & Francis; 2024)
- Canadian Journal of Linguistics* (Cambridge University Press; 2024)
- Journal of Experimental Psychology: Human Perception and Performance* (APA; 2023)
- Bilingualism: Language and Cognition* (Cambridge University Press; 2021-2022)
- Discourse and Cognition* (The Discourse and Cognitive Linguistics Society of Korea; 2021)
- International Review of Applied Linguistics in Language Teaching* (De Gruyter; 2020)
- Southern Journal of Linguistics* (Southeastern Conference on Linguistics; 2020)
- Language Research* (Seoul National University Language Education Institute; 2018-2019)

Other academic services

- 2022 - present || Session chair and discussant for the Association of English Language and Literature in Korea
- 2016 Organizing committee member for The Workshop on Experimental Approaches to East Asian Linguistics, University of Hawaii at Manoa, Honolulu, HI
- 2015 Volunteer for the 4th International Conference on Language Documentation and Conservation, Honolulu, HI
- 2013 - 2016 || Volunteer for East-West Center International Graduate Student Conferences, East-West Center, Honolulu, HI
- 2012 - 2016 || Copy editor for *Reading in a Foreign Language*, 24(1)-26(1); R. Day & T. Hudson, editors, National Foreign Language Resource Center, Honolulu, HI
- 2012 - 2015 || Workshops for acoustic phonetics on formant analysis using Praat
Department of Second Language Studies, University of Hawaii at Manoa
- 2010 Organizing committee member for the Korean Association of Teachers of English(KATE) International Conference at Seoul National University, Seoul, Korea

Administrative Services

2023-2025 || Director of the College English Program
Kunsan National University, Gunsan, Korea

2022-2024 || Member of gender equality committee
Kunsan National University, Gunsan, Korea

Educational Services

2021 Instructor of Pre-College Program for incoming freshmen at Seoul National University

2019 Writer of New Teachers' Guidebook for the College English Program at Seoul National University

Community Services

2019 Daehakdong Study Center, Seoul, Korea (Fall)
Education service for underprivileged children

2019 Nanum Library, Suwon, Korea (Spring)
Education service for underprivileged children

2017 Pyongtaek Jinwi Municipal Library, Pyongtaek, Korea (Fall)
Education service for children in a rural area

2014 - 2015 || East-West Center Participant Association (EWCPA) Board
Served as a board member for EWC Participant Association
Coordinated Saturday movie nights

2012 Honolulu Habitat for Humanities
Helped organize an appreciation gala for build volunteers
Honolulu, HI

2006 Amnesty International Korea
Translated petition letters

LANGUAGE

Natural Languages

Korean (Native); English (Native-like); German (Advanced reading); Japanese (Basic)

Computer Languages & Programs

R, LaTeX, HTML, Python, Matlab, JavaScript
E-Prime, PsychoPy, SMI eye-tracking system, Praat, PennController for IBEX